

SHEENA VAGHELA

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EDUCATION

The University of Texas at Austin , School of Information (3.79 / 4.00)	May 2027
<i>Bachelor of Science in Informatics, Bridging Disciplines Program Design Strategies Certificate</i>	
<i>Master of Science in Information Studies (Human Computer Interaction)</i>	May 2028

EXPERIENCE

Texas Advanced Computing Center - UX Design & Research Assistant	Jun. 2026 - Present
- Designed an educational initiative that gamifies high-performance computing concepts through interactive, restaurant-themed simulations - Authored a user study protocol and conducted user interviews to validate design intent and usability, using mixed-methods research to measure educational impact and technical robustness across diverse user demographics	
Texas Momentum - UX Designer (Tacite.ai)	Feb. 2026 - Apr. 2026
- Synthesized customer discovery interviews to define users, validate pain points, and inform product strategy - Translated user feedback into feature recommendations and roadmap decisions for an early-stage AI startup - Identified usability issues and product bugs through hands-on testing, delivering UX/UI improvements	
Longhorn Developers - UX Designer	Feb. 2025 - Present
- Designed and iterated on a mobile app for Sure Walk, improving ride-request and safety workflows for 20,000+ students through usability testing and research - Conducted user interviews and cohort analysis to identify friction points and validate design decisions - Redesigned onboarding and core UI flows to improve task efficiency and user experience	
Texas Convergent - UX Design Lead	Jan. 2024 - Present
- Led UX research for a mobile app integrated with the iDetect medical device, interviewing nurses to identify workflow pain points and guide design decisions - Designed and launched the MVP of HerdUp, a student organization discovery platform that streamlines how students connect with campus communities, significantly improving engagement and accessibility - Designed and pitched an AI research summarization tool translating academic workflows into a product concept	
iRISE Program - Undergraduate Researcher	Aug. 2025 - May 2026
- Conducted mixed-methods research on how geopolitical narratives influence user perceptions of digital platforms - Analyzed qualitative data to identify behavioral and trust-related patterns in user adoption - Synthesized insights and presented UX-centered recommendations to faculty and research teams	
Develop For Good - Product Designer for SBEE Digital	Jul. 2025 - Aug. 2025
- Designed multi-platform user experiences for electricity application workflows in Benin for low-literacy users - Built personas, journey maps, and end-to-end user flows for applicants, agents, and supervisors - Collaborated with cross-functional teams to translate service problems into scalable solutions impacting 6M+ users	
Texas Cybersecurity Clinic - Cybersecurity Consultant	Jan. 2026 - Apr. 2026
- Evaluated cybersecurity policies and system workflows for usability and operational risk gaps - Translated technical constraints into actionable recommendations for non-technical stakeholders - Collaborated with teams to prioritize improvements balancing security and usability	

HONORS & AWARDS

• Design @UT's Annual Design-a-thon - Excellence in Innovation Award	Nov. 2025
• Texas Convergent Demo Day Pitch Competition (1st Place) - Built an AI research summarizer	May 2024

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Software Tools: Figma, Adobe Illustrator, Framer, Canva, Miro, Jira, Trello, Linear, Zotero, Python

UX & Research Skills: Usability Testing, Competitor Analysis, UX Research (Interviews, Surveys, Heuristic Evaluation, Card Sorting, Task Analysis, Personas), User Flows, Journey Mapping, Accessibility Evaluation

Design & Interaction Skills: Wireframing, Prototyping, Interaction Design, Information Architecture, Agile Methodologies, Design Systems, Design Thinking, Rapid Prototyping

Student Organizations: Texas Convergent, Longhorn Developers, Texas Momentum, Texas Royals, Camp Kesem

Interests: Hiking, Sketching, Playing Tennis, Traveling, Jigsaw Puzzles, Running